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ON THE METRICS AND ORIGIN OF RIG-VEDIC *NÁ* 'LIKE, AS'

0. PRELIMINARIES

0.1. *Sample.*

The analysis of Rig-Vedic metrical structure (quantitative distribution, word-break phenomena) is largely a matter of statistics. Although the analysis of *ná* 'like, as' is only tangentially related to factors of quantity and word-break, the metrical behavior of *ná* in other respects is crucial. A statistical approach is therefore not only justified, but fundamental. The study which follows, then, is based on a tabulation of all occurrences of *ná* in Books 1 through 8 of the Rig-Veda, amounting to approximately 820 attestations.

0.2. *Additional examples.*

Section A of the Appendix lists up to fifteen additional examples for each metrical category discussed below. (Listings of less than fifteen items are exhaustive.) Section B of the Appendix records, in tabular form, the total number of occurrences of each category listed non-exhaustively in section A, as well as the distribution of the occurrences within the individual Books of the Rig-Veda.

0.3. *Notation.*

We adopt the notational scheme used by G. Nagy (*Comparative studies in Greek and Indic meter*, Cambridge, Mass. 1974): '#' = pāda-initial or pāda-final position, and consecutive numbers, e.g. 1, 2, 3, etc., refer to the first, second, third etc. syllables of a pāda. In addition, it is sometimes important to mark certain word-divisions: in what follows, e.g. '6-7-8' denotes a three-syllable word occupying slots 6, 7 and 8 of a pāda.

Finally, unspecified *ná* always refers to the particle of comparison, while the negative particle will be specified as *ná* 'NEG'.

1. THE POSITION OF *NÁ* IN RIG-VEDIC METERS: A SURVEY

With regard to the position of *ná* in the pāda, the grammars and handbooks give no detailed information beyond the somewhat misleading statement that *ná* is enclitic, and therefore generally follows its object of comparison (thus e.g. Renou, *Gramm. véd.* 380; we return to this point below, in section 4.) However, a survey of the

Indo-Iranian Journal **20** (1978) 171–193. *All Rights Reserved.*
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occurrences of *ná* in the various meters of the Rig-Veda shows that the position of *ná* is, on the whole, strikingly fixed. In general, the position of *ná* is somewhat less markedly fixed in the opening than in the closing; it is well known, however, that the closing tends to show more regular metrical features (e.g. quantitative distribution) and to preserve, on occasion, archaic material, both metrical and phraseological – and here the position of *ná* is absolutely rigid.

The position of *ná* in the two predominant trimeter meters is essentially the same. In the closing of a Triṣṭubh or Jagatī pāda, *ná* always occupies the ninth syllable; thus:

Triṣṭubh: # 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 *ná* 10-11 #
Jagatī: # 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 *ná* 10-11-12 #

According to the sample, *ná* appears in this slot 29.5% of the time (150 times out of 509 occurrences of *ná* in Triṣṭubh and Jagatī). We cite the following as examples; in Triṣṭubh:

ágne ví yanti vaníno ná vayā́ḥ (6.13.1b)
'O Agni, they emanate (from you) like branches from a tree'

(For additional examples, see the Appendix, section A1.) Similarly in Jagatī:

śíśīte vájraṃ téjase ná vā́ṃsagaḥ (1.55.1d)
'he whets his bolt for sharpness, like a bull'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A2.)

By far the most frequent position for *ná* (45.4% of the time, 231 out of 509 occurrences) is syllable 3 of the opening, e.g. in Triṣṭubh:

ghṛtáṃ ná śúci matáyaḥ pavante (6.10.2d)
'pure as ghee, (my) thoughts become clear'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A3.) Similarly in Jagatī:

váyo ná sīdann ádhi barhíṣi priyé (1.85.7d)
'they sat down, like birds, on the beloved Barhis-litter'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A4.)

Elsewhere (23.0% of the time, 117 out of 509 occurrences), *ná* appears either in syllable 4 or syllable 5, that is, precisely at the caesura, which in trimeter verse may occur after either the fourth or fifth syllable. In Triṣṭubh, e.g.:

samudráṃ ná sravátaḥ saptá yahvī́ḥ (1.71.7b)
'as the seven youngest streams (join) the sea'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A5.) In slot 5:

ā́ sū́ryo ná bhānumádbhir arkaír (6.4.6a)
'like the sun, with its shining beams'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A6.) Similarly in Jagatī:

samudráṃ ná saṃcáraṇe sanişyávaḥ (1.56.2b)
'as pursuers of gain (reach) the sea on (their) journey'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A7.) Slot 5:

sá párvato ná dharúneşv ácyutaḥ (1.52.2a)
'he (Indra) is unshakable, like a mountain on its foundations'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A8.) Other positions for *ná* in trimeter are wholly exceptional.[1] We arrive, then, at the following scheme for the distribution of *ná* in trimeter verse:

1-2 *ná* (*ná*) (*ná*) 6 7 8 *ná* 10-11 (-12)

In the Gāyatrī octosyllable, *ná* occupies exclusively slots 3 and 5; in slot 3 (50% of the time, 39 out of 78 occurrences of *ná* in Gāyatrī), e.g.:

váyo ná vasatī́r úpa (1.25.4c)
'like birds to their nests'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A9.) In slot 5 (44.8% of the time, 35 out of 78 occurrences):

tigmáśṛṅgo ná váṃsagaḥ (6.16.39b)
'like a bull with sharp-pointed horns'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A10.) The overall scheme # 1-2 *ná* 4 *ná* 6-7-8 # is, then, virtually exceptionless.[2]

As we might expect, *ná* is found in precisely the same two positions in Anuṣṭubh, Paṅkti, and Mahāpaṅkti, as well as in the octosyllabic pādas of the mixed lyric types; for examples, see the Appendix, sections A11–A14. (The attestations of *ná* in dodecasyllabic dimeter pādas will be discussed in section 2 below.) The few archaic hymns which show catalectic octosyllables (Arnold, *Vedic metre* 161) contain only a single instance of *ná* (10.26.3b, in the expected slot 3.) The very sporadic hypersyllabic dimeter pādas were not surveyed: according to Arnold (loc. cit.) such verses are indicative of textual corruption, in some cases, and careless composition in the rest. (The sole example of *ná* in a hypersyllabic trimeter pāda (Arnold 208-9) was silently included above in the regular # 1-2 *ná* . . . group, 8.97.15b.)

It remains to examine the so-called decasyllabic meters, of which the two most important distinct subtypes are the Dvipadā Virāj and the Bhārgavā. (For the sake

of completeness, it was necessary to expand the sample to include the Bhārgavā hymns of Book 10.)

In Dvipadā Virāj, *ná* occupies, without exception, a single position, namely the middle syllable of the five-syllable pāda.[3] Thus a ten-syllable Dvipadā Virāj line, composed of two such pādas, will show *ná* only in slots 3 and 8, e.g.:

rayír ná citrá śúro ná saṃdṛ́g áyur ná prāṇó nítyo ná sūnúḥ (1.66.lab)
'like remarkable wealth, like the sun('s) vision, like life('s) breath, like one's own son'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A15. The extraordinary concentration and frequency of *ná* in the Dvipadā Virāj hymns (see especially the Agni hymns 1.65-70) are exemplified in the above passage, and will be discussed briefly below.)

The Bhārgavā pāda (Arnold 14, 51, 213–14, 240–1) is actually a hendecasyllabic verse with Jagatī closing. (Its precise relation to Jagatī is discussed below.) The position of *ná* in the closing of a Bhārgavā verse, then, is exactly equivalent to the Jagatī closing position, e.g.:

yūyáṃ dhūrṣú prayújo ná raśmíbhir (10.77.5a)
'you are like teams (yoked) in harnesses, (guided) by reins'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A16.) Unlike Triṣṭubh and Jagatī, however, *ná* is never attested in the Bhārgavā sub-type with early caesura, but only in the type with late caesura, i.e. in slot 5:

riśā́daso ná máryā abhídyavaḥ (10.77.3d)
'like suitors who win out over rivals'

(Additional examples: Appendix, section A17). It is possible to hypothesize that this distinction between Bhārgavā and (e.g.) Jagatī, judging from the frequency of *ná* in the Bhārgavā hymns, may be systematic and not accidental; on the other hand, slot 4 in trimeter represents, statistically, by far the least frequent locus of *ná* (approximately 5.3%, cf. 17.7% for slot 5). Given the paucity of Bhārgavā verses actually attested, we may just as easily, perhaps preferably, assume that non-attestation in slot 4 of this Bhārgavā subtype is accidental.

Occurrences of *ná* in other decasyllabic pādas are more rare. In the two additional subtypes identified by Arnold, *ná* occurs five times in Virāṭsthānā verses and once in a Gautamī verse (Arnold 210 ff.). In 2.11 (the only hymn in which Virāṭsthānā verses are common), *ná* occurs twice in slot 8, producing typical Triṣṭubh closing schemes, 2.11.3d (. . . *ná śubhrā́ḥ* #) and 2.11.20c (. . . *ná cakrám* #). In 7.28.3b, *ná* occupies slot 4, at the caesura. The remaining two occurrences in Virāṭsthānā pādas must be regarded as exceptional, and are discussed in section 4. The Gautamī attestation (4.3.12c) reflects a regular trimeter opening sequence # 1-2 *ná* . . . .

In miscellaneous ten-syllable pādas, *ná* occurs six times, again in regular Triṣṭubh closing patterns.[4]

2. *NÁ* AND THE HISTORY OF VEDIC METERS

Based upon the survey just presented, it is possible to indicate certain areas in which the metrical distribution of *ná* may be of some significance in the diachronic analysis of Vedic meters.

In his recent study, Nagy has attempted to define the formal and historical relationships between Vedic dimeter and trimeter, as well as the interrelationships of the various trimeter meters (op. cit., esp. 166–90). The metrical positions of *ná* outlined above provide some confirmation to parts of Nagy's theory, especially in light of his claims regarding the importance of phraseology in diachronic metrics.

The position of *ná* in the closings of Jagatī and octosyllabic pādas supports Nagy's theory that the closing of Vedic trimeter dodecasyllables represents an underlying four-syllable structure identical to the closing of octosyllables. That is, the metrical identity of the two closings (both . . . ⏑ – ⏑ – ⏑ – #) is paralleled by a rigid phraseological identity, i.e.:

Jagatī . . . *ná* 10–11–12 #
8-syll.: . . . *ná* 6–7–8 #

To this we may add the fact that the distribution of *ná* in the closing of dodecasyllabic pādas in lyric meters is identical to that of Jagatī (for examples, see the Appendix, section A18.)

One of Nagy's arguments for the proposed identity concerns the structure of the Uṣṇih-B dodecasyllable,[5] which is transparently composed of conjoined sequences 8 +4: the quadri-syllabic sequence is identical to (and derived from[6]) the octo-syllabic closing. In this meter we find a single occurrence of *ná* in slot 9 (3.10.5c), but also an occurrence in slot 5, representing the original octosyllabic closing (8.12.7c, # *yát sū́ryo 'ná ródasī" ávardhayat* #).

On the basis of an analysis of word-breaks in the Vasiṣṭha-hymns, Nagy argues, in addition (172–3), that the trimeter meters originally contained a word-break after the eighth syllable, which was gradually eroded. The statistics presented are suggestive, but not conclusive. Confirmation, however, comes from *ná* phraseology, which provides clear evidence for an ancestral phraseological unit . . . *ná* 10–11 (–12) #, thus supporting Nagy's claim. (Additional grounds for assigning pre-Vedic status to this unit will be presented below.)

Note that the correspondence . . . *ná* 6–7–8 # ~ . . . *ná* 10–11–12 # cannot be brought to bear on the issue of the historical *precedence* of dimeter or trimeter verse.[7] It may be worthwhile to point out, however, that the colon-extending process envisioned by Nagy, i.e.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8
⇒ # 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 ⋮ 5′ 6′ 7′ 8′ #

finds an exact typological parallel in the 'extra-long' sixteen-syllable Greek and Vedic metrical types discussed by Watkins, *Indo-European Studies II* 446 ff. (Cambridge, Mass. 1975; to appear in the festschrift for L. R. Palmer, forthcoming.)

Nagy argues, in addition, for the historical derivation of Triṣṭubh from Jagatī by means of catalexis of the final syllable, rather than deriving Jagatī from Triṣṭubh by the opposite process of hypersyllabic development.[8] The historical precedence of Triṣṭubh, however, has been claimed by Oldenberg, Arnold, and Macdonell, among others.[9] Most speculation on this point has been based on the facts of so-called 'external contamination' (Arnold 15, 53 ff.), i.e. the alternation of metrical types within single hymns. But such data are essentially inconclusive, since they can be (and have been) used to motivate both catalexis and hypersyllabism. Simple juxtaposition of the Triṣṭubh and Jagatī closings, similarly, while certainly consistent with a catalexis theory (i.e. . . . *ná* 10–11–12 #→ . . . *ná* 10–11–∅ #), does not prove it a priori. But catalexis becomes more plausible if we consider the position of the decasyllabic meters, and Dvipadā Virāj in particular, in the history of trimeter.

According to Nagy (177 ff.), Dvipadā Virāj represents a descendant of Jagatī, with internal catalexis of syllable 6 and external catalexis of syllable 12 (cf. the Bhārgavā late-caesura subtype, with internal catalexis of syllable 6 only; Nagy 181–3, similarly Arnold 213.) In Dvipadā Virāj, as seen already by Arnold (239) and elaborated by Nagy (179 ff.), the element of *symmetry* was the crucial factor in restructuring the quantitative schemes of the two five-syllable pādas. The same factor of symmetry is taken by Nagy as the ultimate force responsible for the symmetrical double catalexis of an earlier 6 + 6 structure. A clear index of this symmetry-producing mechanism is seen in the position and behavior of *ná* in this meter, which is found in the productive (trimeter) slot 3, which becomes the exact metrical equivalent of slot 8 (i.e. old slot 9) in the closing. Thus, for the phraseological units # 1–2 *ná* . . . and . . . *ná* 10–11–12 #, the catalexis of syllables 6 and 12 produced a perfectly symmetrical reinterpretation of an earlier asymmetry in distribution:

1–2 *ná* 4 5 6 7 8 *ná* 10–11–12
⇒ # 1–2 *ná* 4 5 ∅ 7 8 *ná* 10–11 ∅ #

A final symmetry-creating operation, in *ná* phraseology, was the generation of obligatory bisyllabism for 4–5 and 6–7 (i.e. old 7 8), and thus the canonic shape for such phrases is the following (cf. the example provided above in section 1):

1–2 *ná* 4–5 ⋮ 6–7 *ná* 9–10

Note that word-break after 5 is not obligatory in this meter; but the extraordinary concentration of *ná*-structures like the above must certainly point to the role of

symmetry in the formalization, if not the generation, of the structure of Dvipadā Virāj.[10]

The Bhārgavā facts, by themselves, are ambiguous, with regard to a theory of catalexis versus hypersyllabism. But if Bhārgavā is simply a Jagatī-based innovation, as is likely, then catalexis at 6 is the simpler analysis, versus catalexis at 6 plus extension at 12.

Finally, the position of *ná* in Virāṭsthānā and decasyllabic Triṣṭubh verses points to a decasyllabic analog of the asymmetrically-structured Bhārgavā (specifically, the subtype with early caesura), here with external catalexis at 12 (as in Triṣṭubh and Dvipadā Virāj) but internal catalexis at 5 instead of 6.[11]

At the very least, then, the metrical/phraseological behavior of *ná* at the caesura and in the closing of trimeter meters renders more plausible the derivations proposed by Nagy; the situation may be schematized as follows (recall that, in the history of Dvipadā Virāj, *ná* in 4 or 5 was eliminated in favor of *ná* in 3):

Jagatī:	#	1	2	3	*ná*	*ná*	6	7	8	*ná*	10–11–12		#
Triṣṭubh:	#	1	2	3	*ná*	*ná*	6	7	8	*ná*	10–11	∅	#
Bhārg.$_1$:	#	1	2	3	4	*ná*	∅	7	8	*ná*	10–11–12		#
Dvip. Vir.:	#	1	2	3	4	5	∅	7	8	*ná*	10–11	∅	#
Bhārg.$_2$:	#	1	2	3	[*ná*][12]	∅	6	7	8	*ná*	10–11–12		#
10-syll.:	#	1	2	3	*ná*	∅	6	7	8	*ná*	10–11	∅	#

3. ON THE METRICAL POSITION OF *NÁ* 'NEG'

The precise relationship of *ná* with the homonymous negative particle *ná* 'NEG' has long remained obscure in several respects. A brief comparative metrical study will serve two purposes: such a study permits, first, the formulation of certain principles applicable to Rig-Vedic exegesis, and second, reveals the starting-point for the theory discussed in section 4 concerning the origin of the comparative function of *ná*.[13]

To begin, we consider the first four syllables of octosyllabic pādas. Being non-enclitic, *ná* 'NEG' freely occurs in the first syllable. (This is perhaps its most familiar position; examples abound, e.g. 1.25.14abc.) In addition, *ná* 'NEG' occurs in syllable 4 (e.g. 1.25.6b, 1.91.6b, 5.79.10d, 7.32.23b, 8.14.9c, 8.30.1b). It does not appear to occur in syllables 2 or 3. In the closing of octosyllables, however, *ná* 'NEG' occupies the same position as *ná*, namely syllable 5 (e.g. 1.5.4a). We arrive, then, at the following scheme for the distribution of *ná* 'NEG' in octosyllables: # *ná* 2 3 *ná ná* 6–7–8 #.

The situation in trimeter is somewhat more complex. In addition to frequent occurrence, as expected, in syllable 1, *ná* 'NEG' also appears with moderate

frequency at the caesura, i.e. in syllables 4 (e.g. 1.124.6b) and 5 (e.g. 1.102.10a). Syllable 6 constitutes the unmarked post-caesura locus of *ná* 'NEG'[14]; examples in syllable 8 are infrequent, but not sufficiently rare or otherwise suspicious to be deemed exceptional (e.g. 2.23.5b, 3.54.8b, 6.3.2d, 8.60.13c). I am not aware of any examples in syllable 7, and the extremely rare examples which occur in syllable 3 must be considered exceptional, and are discussed specifically below. In the closing, again, both *ná* 'NEG' and *ná* occupy precisely the same position, namely slot 9.[15] Thus for *ná* 'NEG' in trimeter we find the following distribution: # *ná* 2 3 *ná ná ná* 7 *ná ná* 10–11 (–12) #.

Compare, first, the distribution of *ná* in octosyllables; for convenience, we present the schemes for *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' side by side:

ná	# 1–2 *ná* 4 *ná* 6–7–8 #
ná 'NEG'	# *ná* 2 3 *ná ná* 6–7–8 #

In the opening of octosyllables, then, both particles appear in complementary distribution; thus a morpheme of the shape /ná/ in syllable 3 must be the particle of comparison, and must also be the negative particle in syllables 1 and 4.

Consider the trimeter distributions:

ná	# 1–2 *ná ná ná* 6 7 8 *ná* 10–11 (–12) #
ná 'NEG'	# *ná* 2 3 *ná ná ná* 7 *ná ná* 10–11 (–12) #

At this point it is necessary to examine the rare attestations of *ná* 'NEG' in syllable 3 of trimeter meters. I am aware of six cases: all six can be analyzed as principled exceptions, and one of these can also represent an intentional violation of the scheme we have proposed.

It is a distributional fact that *ná* in syllable 3 is preceded, without exception, by a two-syllable word, thus # 1–2 *ná* . . . . Three of the examples of *ná* 'NEG' in this position, however, do not show this structure: 1.164.39c, # *yás tán ná* . . . ; 6.18.8a, # *sá yó ná* . . . ; 8.48.10b, # *yó mā ná* . . . . At this point, it would be possible to hypothesize, mechanically, that word-division in these cases is distinctive, and that therefore these examples do not constitute violations the # 1–2 *ná* . . . . But the appearance of *yá-* in all these examples is suggestive, and in fact the fourth case shows that the explanatory principle is more general:

5.44.9c *átrā ná hárdi kravaṇásya rejate*
d *yátrā* . . .

The explanation must be a syntactic one: if /ná/ appears in slot 3 in a relative or correlative construction, it is unambiguously interpreted as *ná* 'NEG'.

The fifth example is syntactically trivial: 3.32.9d, *nắhā ná mắsāḥ śarádo varanta*; /ná/ in slot 3 here is unambiguously interpretable as *ná* 'NEG', as the second

member of a coordinate negative construction, following pāda-initial *ná* 'NEG'.

A final example (6.66.5a, *# makṣú ná . . .*) occurs in a difficult stanza, and might at first appear to constitute a real counterexample. There are two reasons why this is not the case. First, *ná* 'NEG' participates in a relative construction (*makṣú ná yéṣu dohése cid ayā́*); second, and more interesting, the poet of this hymn is known to have indulged in word-plays and puns of various kinds (see Geldner's introduction to 6.66). It is at least possible that the poet has consciously used *ná* 'NEG' in a structure otherwise associated primarily with *ná* (# 1–2 *ná* . . .); the result, for the hearer, is a momentary pun, based on metrical/phraseological constraints.

According to these analyses, then, *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' can be considered to appear in complementary distribution in the opening of trimeter, just as in dimeter. At the caesura, however, there is complete overlap. There is at least one case where this metrical fact assists in the interpretation of a disputed passage.

In 7.18.9a, the fate of Sudās' enemies, who drowned in the river Paruṣṇī, is described as follows:

īyúr árthaṃ ná nyarthám páruṣṇīm (7.18.9a)

Geldner's translation takes *ná* as the particle of comparison: 'Sie kamen ans falsche Ziel als wäre es ihr richtiges Ziel: in die Paruṣṇī'. But he was aware of the ambiguity, and comments as follows (ad loc.): 'Ist *ná* 'nicht' oder 'wie'? Das Metrum spräche eher dafür, dass der erste Einschnitt vor *ná* fällt, also: zum Ziel, nicht zum falschen Ziel. Natürlich ironisch'.[16] The verse, in fact, is completely ambiguous: both of Geldner's interpretations (*ná* versus *ná* 'NEG') are not only admissible, but *correct* – for the ambiguity, we believe, is intentional. Pace Geldner, there are in fact no metrical grounds whatsoever for deciding between one or the other interpretation: the poet is simply playing upon the complete overlap in distribution between the two particles in this position of the trimeter verse. The beginning of the next stanza continues the fun: *# īyúr gávo ná . . .* is structurally parallel, but semantically unambiguous ('like cows'); the poet is exploring the semantic possibilities of metrical distribution.

In syllable 6, there is again no overlap at all. A morpheme /ná/ in this position must be interpreted as *ná* 'NEG'. Confirmation of this principle is provided by the following passage, where independent evidence proves the interpretation as *ná* 'NEG'. In the description of the yearly cycle in 1.164.48, *ná* appears in slot 6 in 48d:

1.164.48c *tásmin sākáṃ triśatā́ ná śaṅkávo*
d *'rpitā́ḥ ṣaṣṭír ná calācalā́saḥ*

Given the *ná* in 48c (the exceptional position [slot 8] is only apparent; see n. 32), it would be conceivable to analyze the *ná* in 48d as the particle of comparison as

well. But in slot 6, it must be interpreted as negative, and this, in fact, gives the best sense: 'in it are fastened 360 [days], like pins, which do not wander [= are not loosened]'. Geldner interprets similarly, and notes that the Atharvaveda version of this passage (10.8.4, *khī́lā ávicācalā yé* 'pegs that are immovable', Whitney) ensures the interpretation of *ná* as negative. In our view, however, the meter was sufficient to disambiguate the passage; the AV version (with unambiguous negative compound, cf. RV *ávicācali-*) merely confirms the metrical principle here presented.

In another passage, Geldner takes *ná* as representing both particles simultaneously ('*ná* evtl. doppelt zu denken (Haplologie)'):

uśántā dūtā́ ná dábhāya gopā́ (7.91.2a)
'willig wie Boten, als Wächter nicht zu hintergehen'

This interpretation, strictly speaking, is impossible, though it contains a grain of truth. In slot 6, again, *ná* is simply negative; *uśántā dūtā́* and *gopā́* are used as epithets of Vāyu and Indra. But as epithets, they represent implied comparisons, or better, statements of equivalence – thus Geldner is half right; the interpretation as comparisons arises from the poet's play with metaphor, though the particle itself is unambiguously negative, and must be interpreted as such.

We conclude this section with a passage where the proper metrical analysis of an entire stanza yields the correct interpretation for a previously misinterpreted *ná*. In the difficult hymn 5.19, stanza 5 as it appears in the Saṃhitā text is metrically deviant; the standard interpretation is that of Oldenberg, who believed the stanza to consist of one Gāyatrī pāda followed by three Triṣṭubh pādas[17]:

krī́ḷan no raśma ā́ bhuvaḥ
sám bhásmanā vāyúnā vévidānaḥ
tā́ asya san dhṛṣájo ná tigmā́ḥ
súsaṃśitā vakṣyò vakṣaṇesthā́ḥ

Arnold, however, suggested a far more satisfying analysis (246, sub § 28 and Metrical Commentary ad loc., 302): *vāyúnā* is a gloss on *bhásmanā*, and 5b is thus followed by two catalectic dimeter verses[18] and finally an octosyllable, thereby forming a Paṅkti stanza. (Note that the hymn is found in a collection which features, typically, the stanza-structure '1–4 Anuṣṭubh, 5 Paṅkti'; under this analysis, 5.19 becomes, plausibly, '1–2 Trochaic Gāyatrī, 3–4 Anuṣṭubh, 5 Paṅkti'.) The stanza reads, then, as follows:

a *krī́ḷan no raśma ā́ bhuvaḥ*
b *sám bhásmanā vévidānaḥ*
c *tā́ asya san dhṛṣájo*
d *ná tigmā́ḥ súsaṃśitā*
e *vakṣyò vakṣaṇesthā́ḥ*

The interpretation of 5cde is highly uncertain; although Geldner translates only

fragmentarily, he clearly follows the traditional metrical analysis, as shown by his rendering of *ná* as 'wie'. This cannot be correct: if anything is to be made of this passage, one must begin with the fact that *ná* is the negative particle, given its pāda-initial position in 5d.

The complete congruence of *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' in the closing of pādas is of primary importance to the next section.

4. COORDINATE NEGATIVES AND THE ORIGIN OF *NÁ*

Most scholars assume that *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' ultimately represent one and the same particle, namely the Indo-European negative particle **ne*.[19] But the standard explanation for the origin of the comparative function of *ná* is highly unsatisfactory. As exemplar we present Whitney's statement (§ 1122h) that the comparative function of *ná* 'is generally explained as being a modification or adaptation of the negative one: thus, [*although, to be sure*] *not* [*precisely*] *a thirsty buffalo*, and so on' (referring to *gauró ná tṛṣitáḥ piba* (1.16.5c) 'drink like a thirsty buffalo'. For identical formulations, see e.g. Macdonell, op. cit. 236, Renou, op. cit. 380, and references to earlier literature in Mayrhofer, loc. cit.)

This theory is objectionable in several respects. It provides neither a principled syntactic explanation nor a probable semantic one. Further, the 'semi-enclitic' status of *ná*,[20] as well as the facts of metrical distribution receive no systematic explanation. Some further brief consideration of metrical position, however, allows for the construction of a much more powerful hypothesis.

We begin with trimeter. As noted above, *ná* 'NEG' is relatively rare in syllable 8 of a Triṣṭubh or Jagatī pāda, while in the closing *ná* 'NEG' is found only in syllable 9. If another negative precedes it in the pāda, however (slots 1, 4/5, or 6), then the second *ná* 'NEG' in coordinate negative constructions nearly always occupies slot 9.[21] The following is typical of such constructions[22]:

ná yáṃ járanti śarádo ná māśā (6.24.7a)
ná . . . . . . ná 10–11
'whom neither years nor months make old'

As is well known, *ná* 'NEG' negates only a verbal predicate. Thus a coordinate negative sentence such as the preceding one represents, at the deepest level, a structure like the following:

$$_S[[NP_1]_{NP}[[\text{NEG-}V_i][NP_j]]_{VP}] + {}_S[[NP_2]_{NP}[[\text{NEG-}V_i][NP_j]]_{VP}]$$

that is, roughly, *śarádo ná járanti tám* + *māśā ná járanti tám*. Consider the semantic implications of such structures: a conjoined non-negative sequence $x\ (VP_i) + y\ (VP_i)$ necessarily implies that x and y share a number of semantic features, allowing both

x and y to share the same verb. With the addition of negation, the shared characteristics of x and y are still more narrowly restricted – in semantic terms, then, the relationship between x and y in a sequence x (NEG-VP_i) + y (NEG-VP_i) is essentially one of *equivalence*: x is equivalent to y, with respect to (NEG-VP_i). Thus, subtracting the grammatical identity (NEG-VP_i) = (NEG-VP_i), what remains is the semantic relationship $x \cong y$, *'x . . . like/just as y . . .'*: I submit, then, that precisely this equivalence relationship in coordinate negative structures represents the origin of the comparative function of *ná*. In terms of Rig-Vedic diction, this means that the comparative function originated with the equivalence-value of the second member of such constructions, which typically occupies slot 9 in the closing of trimeter pādas. (The explanation for dimeter is the same: here, coordinate negatives generally take the form # *ná* 2 3 4 *ná* 6–7–8 #, e.g. 8.31.16b, 17b, etc.)

According to this explanation, the semantic reinterpretation of *ná* 'NEG', resulting in a new particle *ná* 'like, as' was originally operative within a single pāda, and must have been completed before the attested poems of the Rig-Veda. But we can observe the very same process in the Rig-Veda itself, as shown by the following pair of verses:

ná ta indra sumatáyo ná rā́yaḥ
saṃcákṣe pū́rvā uṣáso ná nū́tnāḥ (7.18.20ab)

Geldner's is the 'unmarked' rendering: 'Deine Gnaden und deine Reichtümer, o Indra, die früheren und die neuesten, sind nicht vollständig aufzuzählen, so wenig wie die Morgenröten'. In our view, however, what underlies this passage is the same semantic reinterpretation discussed above, here extended from a coordinate negative sequence to the following pāda; thus, literally, 'not your favors, O Indra, (and) not your riches, earlier and recent, are to be enumerated, (and) not dawns (either)'.

The theory presented here explains the fact that the distribution of *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' in the closing of pādas is identical, since precisely this position was the locus of diffusion for the comparative function. The metrical congruence rigidly preserved in this part of the pāda, exactly where metrical and phraseological patterns tend to be preserved, reflects the original identity of the two morphemes prior to their subsequent functional divergence.

The present theory accounts as well for other facts of meter and phraseology. Given two competing functions for original sequences . . . *ná* + *N* # (where *N* is a noun), we might expect the new function to be accompanied by some secondary feature. In this case, *ná* in strictly comparative function developed as an enclitic, thereby producing perfect complementary distribution in the openings of pādas, as described above. The fact that the 'new' slot 3 represents, statistically, the most prominent and productive synchronic position of *ná* in all meters is immediately explained as a consequence of this development.

At the beginning of this section, we referred to the 'semi-enclitic' status of *ná*, which received no systematic explanation under the standard theory of the origin of *ná*. By this we refer to the fact that *ná* 'like, as' frequently *precedes* its object of comparison.[23] It is a fact of Rig-Vedic phraseology, however, that this 'semi-enclisis' occurs, on the whole, only in the closing of pādas, and there with great frequency. Thus we find the following patterns of *ná* diction in each of the three basic metrical contexts (*N* = noun, *X* = participial, adjectival etc. modifier):

opening:	# *N* + *ná* (+*X*) . . .
caesura:	. . . (*X*+) *N* + *ná* (+*X*) . . .
closing: (a)	. . . (*X*+) *N* + *ná* (+*X*) #
(b)	. . . (*X*+) *ná* + *N* #

At the caesura, then, sequences **. . . (*X*+) *ná* + *N* . . . are almost unknown, while such patterns freely occur in the closing. Additional facts must be considered at this point. We have described the two patterns of *ná* phraseology, in the closing, as representing 'fully enclitic' *ná* (type *a*), and 'semi-enclitic' *ná* (type *b*). But these designations are somewhat misleading. Concerning the two variants of type (*b*): the pattern . . . *ná* + *N* # is extremely rare, while the standard manifestation is the sequence . . . *X* + *ná* + *N* #. These facts may mean that even for type (*b*), *ná* was already fully enclitic, in terms of the phonological phrase.

The present theory explains the phraseological distribution of *ná*, therefore, as follows: starting from original sequences . . . *ná* + *N* #, *ná* in comparative function developed enclitic status, which is visible in the distribution of *ná* throughout the pāda. In the closing, however, *ná* optionally retains its original phraseological position, i.e. before its object of comparison.

But enclisis is not the only feature which distinguishes *ná* from *ná* 'NEG'. While *ná* 'NEG' regularly contracts with a following vowel, *ná* 'like, as' does not (Wackernagel, *Ai. Gramm.* I[2] 307; Macdonell, *Ved. gramm.* § 67). The standard explanation of the non-contraction of *ná* as a secondary marker[24] to preserve the semantic distinction between *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' is doubtless correct, but can be further refined, given the analysis just presented. The only logical rationale for the origin of such a distinct treatment is to be sought in the need for distinguishing sequences . . . *ná* 'NEG' + *V*- . . . from . . . *ná* + *V*- . . . . This in itself corroborates our hypothesis according to which *ná* is derived from original sequences . . . *ná* 'NEG' + *N* #. In fact, uncontracted *ná* typically occurs precisely in sequences . . . (*X*+) *ná* + *N* #[25], both supporting the general theory of the origin of the comparative function of *ná*, and providing a much more specific context for the origin of the non-contraction rule.

The development of enclisis and non-contraction for *ná* calls for brief general comment. The analysis presented above makes the assumption that the situation

we envision – competing functions for a single morpheme in a fixed position – is an unstable one, leading to secondary formal characterization for the new function. Comparative evidence supports this assumption. In West and South Slavic, Indo-European **ne* appears again in comparative function, characterized by secondary suffixation, and generally restricted to absolute comparison following comparatives (a natural extension of the Vedic usage): e.g. Old Church Slavic *neže, neželi* 'than' (Cf. Czech *než, nežli* 'id.'), *nebo* 'or', Serbo-Croatian *nego* 'than'.[26] In East Slavic, however, **ne* appears uncharacterized in usages identical with Vedic *ná* (in addition to its negative function): *ne*, in Russian *byliny*, is well-attested in the meaning 'like, as'.[27] But note that multiple negation in Old Russian makes use of both *ne* and the characterized negative *ni* (cf. Old Latin *nei*, etc.) in sequences for which only '*ni* . . . *ni* . . . ' is possible in Contemporary Standard Russian. The details of the history of negative constructions in Russian are complex, and remain to be worked out in full; but there is evidence, at any rate, that in multiple negative constructions, the use of the characterized negative *ni* is secondary.[28]

The situation in Baltic is more complex. Both the simple negative particle *nè* and the characterized form *neĩ* (used in conjoined constructions) are found in the meaning 'than' after comparatives, versus acute *néi* 'like, as, as if, to some extent' (see Fraenkel, *Lit. etymol. Wb.* s.v. *nè* and *neĩ* for discussion and further references.)

We have, then, no general criteria for determining the direction of secondary characterization in the case of **ne* 'NEG' versus **ne* in comparative function. The positional 'instability' of Balto-Slavic **ne*, furthermore, is purely hypothetical, since the attestations do not generally occur within a closed and relatively rigorous system, such as that of Rig-Vedic meter. What is most likely is that a complex of language-specific (and genre-specific) factors determines which morpheme is characterized in the event of functional split, as well as the specific means of secondary marking. That Vedic resorts to enclisis and non-contraction, in the case of *ná*, is perhaps not surprising, in view of the phonotactic resources available to Rig-Vedic Sanskrit and the *CV́* structure of the particle, aside from the metrical implications already discussed.[29]

We conclude this section with some final observations on the relationship between phraseology and meter as shown by the particle *ná*.

Nagy has investigated the role of phraseology in the generation of quantitative distribution and fixed word-break patterns, and conversely, the regulatory power of established metrical structures on incoming phraseology (see esp. p. 196.) According to the hypothesis presented above concerning the origin of *ná*, and considering the synchronic distribution of *ná*, we can view processes similar to those described by Nagy. Here, however, phraseology does not interact with metrical structure (quantitative distribution, etc.), but rather with itself, suggesting a minor elaboration of Nagy's system.

Consider, first, the origin of *ná*: the semantics of *ná* 'NEG' phraseology in the closing of coordinate negative pādas led to a functional divergence, in the first instance, and finally to a formal divergence (enclisis, non-contraction) – the result was the generation of new patterns of fixed phraseology, i.e. those with *ná* 'like, as'. The interaction of these two separate patterns is clearly visible in the synchronic metrical distributions of *ná* and *ná* 'NEG', as described above. But this system of peaceful coexistence, as it were, could be subjected to a new disruption, this time from the newly-created *ná* phraseology itself. Consider those exceptions to the expected distribution of *ná* in octosyllables which show *ná* in syllable 4. There are nine cases, which show the following openings:

(1)	*#samudró ná . . .*	1.30.3c	(Gāyatrī)
(2)	*#aruṣáṃ ná . . .*	4.15.6b	(Gāyatrī)
(3)	*#tū́rṇāśaṃ ná . . .*	8.32.4b	(Gāyatrī)
(4)	*#áśvāso ná . . .*	8.55.4c	(Gāyatrī)
(5)	*#yám mitráṃ ná . . .*	5.16.1c	(Anuṣṭubh)
(6)	*#arbhakó ná . . .*	8.69.15a	(Anuṣṭubh)
(7)	*#samudré ná . . .*	1.48.3d	(Bṛhatī)
(8)	*#paraśúr ná . . .*	1.127.3c	(Atyaṣṭi)
(9)	*#agnáyo ná . . .*	5.87.3d[30]	

Compare the trimeter attestations of *ná* in slot 4: of thirty cases, two-thirds show evidence of fixed traditional phraseology, as the following groupings indicate:

(1)	*samudrá-* (8X):	*#samudráṃ ná . .*	1.52.4b	(Jagatī)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	1.56.2b	(Jagatī)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	1.71.7b	(Triṣṭubh)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	1.190.7b	(Triṣṭubh)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	3.46.4d	(Triṣṭubh)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	4.55.6c	(Triṣṭubh)
		#samudráṃ ná . .	6.36.3c	(Triṣṭubh)
		#samudré ná . .	6.19.5d	(Triṣṭubh)
(2)	*X-āsaḥ* (8X):	*#áśvāso ná . . .*	1.148.3d	(Triṣṭubh)
		#átyāso ná . . .	7.56.16a	(Triṣṭubh)
		#śyenā́so ná . . .	4.6.10c	(Triṣṭubh)
		#vatsā́so ná . . .	7.56.16d	(Triṣṭubh)
		#vavrā́so ná . . .	1.168.2a	(Jagatī)
		#sómāso ná . . .	1.168.3a	(Jagatī)
		#putrā́so ná . . .	1.130.1f	(Atyaṣṭi)
		#jyéṣṭhāso ná . . .	5.87.9c[30]	

(3)	*X-áyaḥ* (4X):	*#agnáyo ná . . .*	2.28.2d	(Triṣṭubh)
		#agnáyo ná . . .	2.34.1c	(Jagatī)
		#giráyo ná . . .	6.66.11d	(Triṣṭubh)
		#giráyo ná . . .	1.64.7b	(Jagatī)

(4) *other* (10X): Triṣṭubh: *#árvanto ná . . .* (7.90.7a[31], 7.93.3c), *#camrīṣó ná . . .* (1.100.12c), *#admasán ná . . .* (1.124.4c), *#mṛgáṇāṃ ná . . .* (1.190.4c), *#adroghó ná . . .* (6.12.3c), *#prá śyenó ná . . .* (6.20.6a)

Jagatī: *#sátvāno ná . . .* (1.64.2d), *#tṛṣṇáje ná . . .* (5.57.1d)

Bṛhatī: *#vánāni ná . . .* (8.1.13c)

It is clear, then, that the synchronically exceptional octosyllabic examples (1), (4), (7) and (9) merely reflect the trimeter formulas (1), (2) and (3). Thus we see the interaction of secondary phraseological units, resulting in synchronic distributional irregularity on the level of phrase-meter correlations.

A similar, but slightly different situation appears in the trimeter exceptions which show *ná* in the extremely rare slot 8; there are nine occurrences in Books 1–8:

(1)	*. . . ná práyukti #*	6.11.1b	(Triṣṭubh)
	. . . ná práyuktir #	1.153.2a	(Virāṭsthānā)
	. . . ná práyuktiṣu #	1.151.8b	(Jagatī)
[cf.	*. . . ná práyukti #*	10.30.1b	(Triṣṭubh)]
(2)	*. . . ná pravátvān #*	1.181.3a	(Triṣṭubh)
	. . . ná prátīkam #	6.50.8c	(Triṣṭubh)
(3)	*. . . ná srávantīḥ #*	1.174.9b	(Virāṭsthānā)
	. . . ná prīṇānó #	1.73.1c	(Triṣṭubh)
	. . . ná śritā́ny #	2.28.8c	(Triṣṭubh)
	. . . ná śríyaṃ sād #	5.45.2a	(Triṣṭubh)

The forms in (1) reflect, again, a piece of traditional phraseology (note that these occurrences represent all of the attestations of *práyukti-* in the Rig-Veda.) We suggest, further, that groups (2) and (3) represent successively remote phraseological imitations of the patterns of (1), but on the level of phonetic analogy; that is, we take group (1), and perhaps other groups like it which do not survive, to be the source of the extremely limited phonetic inventory found synchronically in groups (2) and (3), i.e. *pra-/prī/sra-/śri-*. (It is perhaps not accidental that some of the rare occurrences of *ná* 'NEG' in slot 8 also show . . . *ná pra-*, e.g. 6.3.2d, 8.60.13c.) Other hypotheses relating these forms are by no means excluded; but what is clear is that *ná* in slot 8 is not exceptional, but merely unproductive, in much the same way as slot 2, with which we conclude.[32]

The synchronically productive slot 3 for *nâ* in all meters (versus e.g. slot 2) is a function of phraseological constraints: the enormous stock of two-syllable words available to the Vedic poets was responsible for the development of a large number of formulas of the shape # 1–2 *nâ* . . ., which contributed to the productive fixation in slot 3. The following partial list of stock openings could easily be expanded in both directions:

#divó nâ . . .:	1.100.3a, 6.3.7a, 6.20.2a, 8.12.6c, 9.16.7a, 9.86.9a, 9.97.30a . . .
#gắvo nâ . . .:	1.25.16b, 1.91.13b, 1.92,4d, 1.95.6b, 8.9.19b, 8.46.30a . . .
#âtyo nâ . . .:	1.56.1b, 1.58.2c, 6.2.8d, 6.4.5d, 9.86.3a . . .
(etc.)	

Thus the extremely rare synchronically 'exceptional' sequence # 1 *nâ* . . . may well represent an old and unexceptional bit of *nâ* phraseology, which failed to become productive and all but disappeared under the weight of the # 1–2 *nâ* . . . formulas.[33]

5. A NOTE ON THE SYNTAX OF *NÁ*

A thorough investigation of the syntax of *nâ* is beyond the scope of this paper.[34] But some brief observations on the syntactic behavior of *nâ* are relevant to the theory of the origin of *nâ* presented above.

It is a regular feature of coordinate negative sentences in the Rig-Veda (examples listed in n. 22) that a verb of one of the conjuncts undergoes so-called 'VP-Deletion', as in the line discussed above in section 4, *nâ yáṃ jâranti śarâdo nâ* [*jâranti*] *mắsā*. The syntactic behavior of *nâ* 'like, as' is identical: VP-Deletion of exactly the same sort is not only frequent, but typical of *nâ* constructions.[35] Thus the deletion properties of *nâ* are readily explained by the fact that the progenitor of *nâ*, namely *nâ* 'NEG' in the closing of pādas with coordinate negatives, characteristically involved an identical deletion process.

Pischel (*Ved. Stud.* I 91 ff.) was disturbed by this feature of *nâ* constructions, and sought to explain it by means of a process of 'case-attraction' between the object of the surface verb and the complement of *nâ*. Under the present analysis, such an explanation is entirely superfluous and unprincipled, and fails to capture the shared syntactic behavior of *nâ* and *nâ* 'NEG'.[36]

A fact noted by Pischel raises possible counter-evidence against the deletion analysis, namely the fact that *iva* seems to participate in such constructions as well. A proper refutation would demand another study, but we can indicate briefly three reasons why the *iva* facts do not, in our view, represent real counter-evidence.

First, although we do not have exact statistics, it is likely that a survey of

comparison in the Rig-Veda would show that while deletion (or 'attraction') is regular and frequent with *ná*, it is altogether rare with *iva*, which is found most frequently with nominatives.

Second, while *iva* and *ná* seem often to overlap in usage, they are not semantically identical. Unlike *ná*, *iva* often occurs in rather more attenuated, almost parenthetical, comparisons ('*x*-like, *x*-ish, *x*-y, sort of (like) *x*', etc.; see Renou op. cit. 379.) In such cases, there is no question of deletion. Note that it is precisely this attenuated usage of *iva* which became productive in Classical Sanskrit (Renou, *Gramm. sanscr.* 520). This basic semantic distinction is at least consistent with a theory which assumes an underlying syntactic distinction between the two particles, as is necessary under the analysis we have proposed.

Third, consider the relatively frequent passages which use both *ná* and *iva* together, in a series of parallel comparisons.[37] It is striking that in all such cases of which I have knowledge, *neither* particle ever appears with unambiguous deletion (i.e. the complements of both are always in the nominative case.) This feature, if statistically valid, strongly suggests that deletion with *iva* is somehow secondary.

Given these arguments, the isolated cases where *iva* appears to involve the same sort of deletion as *ná* are not especially disquieting: they may simply be the result of a syntactic analogy after the usage of *ná*; the fact that *ná* and *iva* overlap in usage with nominative complements is a reasonable starting-point, though perhaps not a motivation, for such an analogy.

6. SUMMARY

Beginning with the synchronic metrical distribution of *ná* and *ná* 'NEG', we attempted to formulate, first, certain principles of Rig-Vedic exegesis (which we applied to several obscure or hitherto imperfectly understood passages), and second, a theory concerning the origin of the comparative function of *ná*. Unlike previous explanations, the theory described above accounts in a systematic way for the formal, functional, and metrical features of *ná*.

We considered, in addition, the following theoretical points: possible implications of *ná* phraseology for the historical analysis of Rig-Vedic meters; the lack of universal principles, as yet, for predicting the direction and nature of secondary marking in the case of functional split of a particle; the interaction of secondary phraseological patterns with original phraseology, resulting in synchronic irregularity in metrical distribution.

Finally, we suggested that the syntactic behavior of *ná* and *ná* 'NEG' confirms the theory presented here concerning the origin of *ná*.

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APPENDIX: ADDITIONAL EXAMPLES AND DISTRIBUTIONAL TABLE

A. ADDITIONAL EXAMPLES

Up to 15 examples (in addition to those already given in section 1) are listed for each category; listings of less than 15 examples are exhaustive. Non-exhaustively listed categories are starred, and are further tabulated below, section B.

*A1. *Slot 9, Triṣṭubh*: 1.51.14b, 1.72.10c, 2.4.6a, 2.20.1b, 3.1.14b, 3.55.21c, 4.19.7a, 4.58.7c, 5.3.2c, 5.41.10c, 6.64.3d, 6.66.6b, 7.19.1a, 7.36.3b, 7.103.3c

*A2. *Slot 9, Jagatī*: 1.55.3a, 1.64.11b, 1.85.1a, 1.92.3a, 1.112.2b, 1.143.3c, 1.160.2c, 1.168.5c, 1.168.7c, 2.13.5c, 3.2.10b, 5.59.4c, 6.8.5d, 6.15.5b, 6.68.9d

*A3. *Slot 3, Triṣṭubh*: 1.62.7c, 1.190.4b, 2.4.6b, 2.31.7d, 3.38.1b, 3.46.5b, 4.7.11d, 4.20.5b, 5.12.1c, 5.41.4d, 6.63.1b, 7.37.4b, 7.103.2b, 8.48.6a, 8.96.11b

*A4. *Slot 3, Jagatī*: 1.106.1c, 1.119.7b, 1.168.7a, 2.2.4d, 2.25.3a, 2.34.8c, 3.2.1b, 3.26.5d, 4.40.3b, 4.45.6b, 5.36.3a, 5.59.2b, 6.15.2a, 8.46.30a, 8.48.5b

*A5. *Slot 4, Triṣṭubh*: 1.100.12c, 1.124.4c, 1.190.4c, 2.28.2d, 3.46.4d, 4.6.10c, 4.55.6c, 6.12.3c, 6.19.5d, 6.20.6a, 6.36.3c, 6.66.11d, 7.56.16a, 7.90.7a, 7.93.3c

*A6. *Slot 5, Triṣṭubh*: 1.33.6c, 1.59.3a, 1.173.3d, 2.14.11c, 2.19.2c, 3.35.1b, 3.58.4d, 4.5.5a, 4.6.7c, 4.10.4d, 5.36.1c, 5.43.7b, 6.66.2a, 7.18.10a, 7.64.5b

A7. *Slot 4, Jagatī*: 1.52.4b, 1.64.2d, 1.64.7b, 1.168.2a, 1.168.3a, 2.34.1c, 5.57.1d

*A8. *Slot 5, Jagatī*: 1.55.2a, 1.141.11a, 1.143.7b, 1.156.1a, 2.2.2b, 2.16.7a, 2.16.8d, 2.31.1c, 2.34.2b, 2.34.4d, 2.34.5c, 3.2.1d, 5.54.8b, 5.54.15b, 6.15.5d

*A9. *Slot 3, Gāyatrī*: 1.25.16b, 1.27.1a, 1.30.21c, 1.38.8b, 1.91.13b, 4.15.7c, 4.31.4b, 8.2.2c, 8.6.23b, 8.7.19b, 8.7.26c, 8.32.5c, 8.44.29b, 8.74.2b, 8.75.9c

*A10. *Slot 5, Gāyatrī*: 1.8.7c, 1.25.3b, 1.30.15c, 1.37.6c, 1.38.1b, 2.8.4a, 3.41.5c, 4.15.6a, 4.52.5b, 5.61.3c, 6.45.22c, 8.3.23c, 8.45.5b, 8.83.9a, 8.102.12a

*A11. *Slot 3, Anuṣṭubh*: 1.176.2d, 4.48.1b, 5.7.7b, 5.9.4b, 5.16.2d, 5.17.3c, 5.66.2d, 6.2.6c, 6.44.3b, 8.9.8d, 8.9.19b, 8.31.14d, 8.34.3b, 8.34.5b, 8.69.8d

*A12. *Slot 5, Anuṣṭubh*: 1.84.1d, 1.175.3d, 4.47.2d, 5.9.4d, 5.10.2d, 5.19.3d, 5.19.4a, 5.52.14b, 5.74.5b, 6.2.1b, 6.2.1d, 6.2.4d, 8.74.10b, 8.74.14d, 8.95.1d

A13. *Slot 3, misc. 8-syll. and (mixed lyric) 12-syll.*

A13a. *Paṅkti*: 1.105.7d, 1.105.8c

A13b. *Mahāpaṅkti*: 5.86.6c, 8.39.3b, 8.41.10e

A13c. *Uṣṇih*: 5.51.7c, 8.12.4b, 8.12.6c, 8.12.13c, 8.13.8b, 8.23.8c, 8.24.21c, 8.25.15c, 8.25.19c, 8.98.4c, 8.98.8a

A13d. *Kakubh*: 8.20.13c, 8.21.1b

A13e. *Bṛhatī*: 1.39.1b, 3.45.4b, 6.48.14d, 7.81.3d, 8.1.23c, 8.33.1b, 8.49.3c, 8.50.3c, 8.61.5c, 8.66.11d, 8.70.3c, 8.87.1b, 8.89.7c, 8.103.6c

A13f. *Satobṛhatī*: 1.39.10d, 5.56.3c, 7.32.2b, 7.32.2d, 7.32.3b, 8.1.2b, 8.3.18d, 8.4.10a, 8.19.33c, 8.27.22b, 8.49.6a, 8.50.2c, 8.88.2b, 8.103.7a

A13g. *5.87*[30]: 5.87.5a
A13h. *Atyaṣṭi*: 1.127.1c, 1.127.8e, 1.129.6b, 1.130.6b, 1.130.8f, 1.131.2f, 1.131.7f, 1.133.6c, 1.138.2c
A14. *Slot 5, misc. 8-syll. only*
A14a. *Paṅkti*: 5.64.7c
A14b. *Mahāpaṅkti*: 8.41.6d, 8.47.3b, 8.47.8c
A14c. *Uṣṇih*: 8.25.2a
A14d. *Kakubh*: 8.20.13a
A14e. *Puraüṣṇih*: 8.70.15c
A14f. *Bṛhatī*: 1.36.13b, 1.39.9d, 5.56.4b, 6.48.1d, 6.48.14a, 7.32.12b, 7.81.4d, 8.1.19d, 8.33.8a, 8.49.5b, 8.50.5b, 8.51.3d, 8.66.1d, 8.99.3d, 8.103.2b
A14g. *Satobṛhatī*: 5.53.16b, 6.46.2d, 8.19.8b, 8.70.2d, 8.99.6b
A14h. *5.87*[30]: 5.87.8d
A14i. *Atyaṣṭi*: 1.127.5e, 1.127.11g, 1.128.5c, 1.129.1g, 1.129.2g, 1.130.2c, 1.131.2d, 1.132.5g, 1.137.3a (see Arnold 249, #77), 1.139.1g
A14j. *Atidhṛti*: 1.127.6h
*A15. *Slot 3 = Slot 8, Dvipadā Virāj*: 1.65.9a, 1.66.3a, 1.66.5a, 1.66.6b, 1.66.7b, 1.66.9b, 1.67.5a, 1.68.9a, 1.691a, 1.69.1b, 1.69.3b, 1.70.11a, 7.34.1d, 7.34.7b, 8.19.27a
A16. *Slot 8, Bhārgavā*: 10.77.1d, 2cd, 3ab, 4a; 10.78.4d
A17. *Slot 5, Bhārgavā*: 10.77.1abc, 2b, 3c, 4bd; 10.78.1b, 2d, 3bcd, 4bc, 6d
A18. *Slot 9, 12-syll. mixed lyric*
A18a. *Uṣṇih*: 3.10.5c
A18b. *Bṛhatī*: 3.45.1c
A18c. *Satobṛhatī*: 8.19.8a, 8.49.6c
A18d. *Atyaṣṭi*: 1.128.5b, 1.128.7b, 1.130.2b, 1.130.2f, 1.138.2a

B. DISTRIBUTIONAL TABLE

The following table records the total number of examples and the distribution in Books 1–8 of the Rig-Veda of those categories non-exhaustively listed in section A above.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	total
A1	40	5	6	34	9	14	23	0	131
A2	13	1	1	0	1	3	0	0	19
A3	52	5	9	24	16	32	23	4	165
A4	33	13	8	4	5	3	0	3	66
A5	6	1	1	2	0	5	4	0	19
A6	16	4	2	10	4	10	22	0	68
A8	9	9	1	0	2	2	0	0	23
A9	9	0	1	2	0	2	2	23	39
A10	7	1	1	2	1	6	0	17	35

Distributional table continued

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	total
A11	1	0	0	1	6	5	0	6	19
A12	2	0	0	1	11	6	0	3	23
A15	39	0	0	0	0	0	4	1	44

NOTES

[1] Exceptions to these positions amount to 2.1%. We re-examine the status of these trimeter 'exceptions' (including those in decasyllabic meters) in section 4 below.

[2] See section 4 for discussion of the dimeter exceptions.

[3] Similarly in the five-syllable pādas of the isolated 'Padapaṅkti' hymn 4.10 (structure 5.5.5.(5.)11.), 1bc, 3c, 6a.

[4] 1.186.7c, 2.4.3b, 4.1.19c, 5.41.12c, 6.20.7b, 6.66.10c. (Both 5.41.12c and 6.66.10c may alternatively be analyzed as isolated Dvipadā Virāj pādas.)

[5] For this meter (= Arnold's 'Dimeter Uṣṇih') and its relationship to standard Uṣṇih (= Nagy's 'Uṣṇih-A'), see Nagy 168, with further references; for Nagy's argumentation, see 171 ff.

[6] Arnold 162–3.

[7] As Watkins points out (*Indo-European Studies* II 430 n. 16, Cambridge, Mass. 1975; to appear in *HSCP* 80, 1976), Nagy's position is equivalent to that of Ananthanarayana (*Acta Ling. Hafn.* 14, (1973), 168), who claims that trimeter is to be derived from dimeter; aliter Watkins, *Celtica* 6, (1963), 217, 242.

[8] For catalexis as a diachronic metrical process, see Watkins, *Celtica* 6, 234 ff.

[9] Oldenberg, *Prolegomena* 43 ff.; Arnold 20, 171; Macdonell, *Ved. gramm. for students* 442. For a specific refutation of Oldenberg's arguments, see Nagy 285–6.

[10] Arnold's observation (202) that the long ninth syllable in this meter 'marks the divergence of Dvipadā Virāj from the parent Triṣṭubh' is unnecessarily misleading: syllable 9 of Dvipadā Virāj corresponds, historically, to syllable 10 of Triṣṭubh (and Jagatī), for which length is precisely expected.

[11] Virāṭsthānā and the scattered decasyllabic Triṣṭubh verses are identical with regard to the syncopated fifth syllable; they differ with respect to quantitative distribution following the caesura.

[12] As noted in section 1 above, non-attestation of *ná* in this position may well represent an accidental gap.

[13] The behavior of *ná* 'NEG' in Rig-Vedic diction is perhaps more familiar than that of *ná* (see e.g. J. Gonda, *La place de la particule négative NÁ dans la phrase en vieil indien*, Leiden 1951); for this reason, we provide only brief indications for the various phenomena discussed, except where exhaustive or near-exhaustive information is crucial to the argument.

[14] As we shall see below, the frequency of *ná* 'NEG' in this position is to be contrasted with the complete absence of *ná* in the same position; the following list is nearly exhaustive for Books 1–8: 1.124.3d, 1.124.6ad, 1.136.1f, 1.145.2a, 1.148.5c, 1.164.32a, 1.164.38d, 1.164.48d, 2.23.4b, 2.30.1b, 3.1.9d, 3.32.8b, 3.53.14b, 5.2.1bc, 5.85.6c, 6.69.8a, 7.31.11c, 7.76.3d, 7.82.7b.

[15] For *ná* 'NEG', I am aware of only two exceptions, namely 4.13.5b (pāda-final position, Triṣṭubh), and 5.44.13d (syllable 10, Jagatī).

[16] Note that the sarcastic tone implied by this interpretation is quite in keeping with the rest of the hymn, where similar semi-comical ironies are frequent.

[17] Oldenberg, *Noten* I 322; the Anukramaṇī vacuously designates the stanza as *virāḍrūpā* (cf. Geldner); such a stanza occurs only here.

[18] Catalectic octosyllables are relatively frequent in Trochaic Gāyatrī contexts (stanzas 1 and 2 of this hymn are composed in Trochaic Gāyatrī, as is 5b itself, removing *vāyúnā*.)

[19] For some divergent etymological speculation, see the references in Mayrhofer, *Kurzgef. etymol. Wb. des Ai.* s.v. *ná* 'like, as', and Vasmer, *Russ. etymol. Wb.* s.v. *ne*[2].

[20] i.e. the semienclitic vs. fully enclitic status of *ná*, not (semi-)enclitic *ná* vs. non-enclitic *ná* 'NEG'; we expand upon this point below.

[21] I refer to consecutive negative structures of the type '*not x . . . not y . . .*' (or '*neither x nor y*'), and not to the one or two semantically difficult cases of alleged *double* negatives (= single negative, etc.) cited in the handbooks.

[22] Additional examples are frequent in trimeter, e.g. 1.162.21a, 2.27.11ab, 2.27.13c, 2.33.15b, 2.38.9a, 3.56.1a, 4.17.19d, 4.25.5a, 4.25.6c, 5.54.7ab, 6.22.11c, 6.25.5a, 6.67.9c, 7.18.20a, 7.22.8c, 7.32.23a, 7.61.5b, 7.99.2a.

[23] Macdonell's statement (236) that '*ná* always follows the word of comparison to which it belongs' is simply wrong, as is Whitney's (§1122g) to the effect that *ná* has the same 'position and value' as *iva*. (For the 'value' of *iva* vs. *ná*, see also section 5 below.) That *ná* can precede its object was already seen by A. Bergaigne, 'La syntaxe des comparaisons védiques' (*Mélanges L. Renier* 75–101, Paris 1886); for discussion of this point, with additional references, see H. Oldenberg, *ZDMG* **61**, (1907), 815 ff.

[24] Or 'minor rule', or 'minus-rule feature', etc., in current parlance.

[25] e.g. 7.22.1c, *sotúr bāhúbhyāṃ súyato nárvā* (metrically . . . *ná árvā* #), '. . . from the arms of the presser, like a well-directed race-horse'.

[26] Vasmer, loc. cit. For the meaning 'than', compare the parallel (but independent) development of dialectal English *nor* in the meaning 'than' after comparatives, pointed out to me by Calvert Watkins. An extensive list of attestations can be found in J. Wright, *The English dialect dictionary* IV (London 1903), s.v.

[27] The behavior of *ne* 'like, as' in Russian *byliny* (a metrically archaic verse-form, see R. Jakobson, *Oxford Slavonic Papers* 3, 1952, 39 ff.) is highly suggestive, and deserving of further investigation. A preliminary survey reveals the following facts: (1) *ne* occurs almost exclusively in recurrent and archaic formulas; (2) VP-Deletion (see section 5) is rare (i.e. *ne* 'like, as' is syntactically identical to simple *ne* 'NEG'); (3) *ne* is generally restricted to verse-initial position; (4) *ne* nearly always occurs in consecutive constructions (*ne x . . ., ne y . . .*). The following is a typical example of double *ne*:

> *ne černyj voron vpered letit*
> *i ne belyj krečet von vypurxivaet,*
> *idet-stupaet staryj Danila Ignat'evič*
> 'as a black raven flies ahead,
> and as a white gyrfalcon flies up into view,
> old Danila Ignat'evič comes stepping (on his way)'
> (P. Rybnikov, *Pesni*[2] II, # 104, 11. 303–5, Moscow 1910)

An example of single *ne*:

> *tak ne molnija tut po čistu polju promolnila*
> *proexal-to Dobrynja na dobrom kone*
> 'just as lightning lightened here through a clear field,
> well, Dobrynja rode through on his fine steed'
> (Rybnikov, *Pesni*[2] I, # 8, 11. 275–6, Moscow 1909)

[28] For a survey of the history of negative constructions, see V. Borkovskij and P. Kuznecov, *Istoričeskaja grammatika russkogo jazyka* 437–43 (Moscow 1965); for examples of multiple negatives, see I. Sreznevskij, *Materialy dlja slovarja drevne–russkago jazyka* (St. Petersburg 1893 ff.) s.v. *ni*.

[29] Similarly, the proclitic status of Slavic *ne* is surely of great importance in the analysis of the Slavic data. For a possible typological parallel, cf. Latin non-enclitic (affirmative) *nam* (utterance-initial) versus enclitic (indefinite, interrogative) *-nam* (*quisnam* etc.), where Old Latin

shows traces of 'independent' (non-enclitic ?) interrogative *nam* (e.g. Plautus, Bacch. 1114, *quid tibi ex filio nam, opsecro, aegrest* ?, Ernout-Meillet *Dict. etymol.* s.v. *nam.*) Cf. also enclitic versus non-enclitic *donc* in French, Russian indefinitizing enclitic *-to* versus demonstrative *to*, etc.

[30] Wrongly Atijagatī (Anukramaṇī, Geldner, etc.); see Arnold 248 (# 63) for other occurrences of this meter in the Rig-Veda (12.12.12.8.8.)

[31] = 7.91.7a.

[32] Excluding slot 8 in trimeter, only three real exceptions remain: two cases in slot 7 (1.149.2a, Triṣṭubh, and 1.133.6b, Atyaṣṭi, both metrically irregular in other respects), and a unique case in slot 11 (7.68.8c, Triṣṭubh, . . . *apó ná* #). The apparently exceptional 1.164.8c discussed above in section 3 (p. 179), with *ná* in slot 8, is best analyzed as a Jagatī verse with rest at slot 5, and regular Jagatī closing (see Arnold 215, and Metrical Commentary ad loc.); thus *ná* appears in its normal closing position.

[33] There are three examples in Books 1–8: 1.130.3b (Atyaṣṭi), 6.3.5d (Triṣṭubh), both # *vér ná* . . . (cf. also 9.72.5d, also # *vér ná* . . .), and 2.2.5d, # *dyaúr ná* . . . (Jagatī; cf. 6.20.1a, also # *dyaúr ná* . . ., but perhaps to be scanned # 1–2 *ná* . . .).

[34] For general discussions of the syntax of comparison in the Rig-Veda, see J. Gonda, *Ellipsis, brachylogy and other forms of brevity in speech in the Rgveda* 50 ff. (Amsterdam 1960), and the references cited in n. 23 above. Several syntactically difficult usages of *ná* are discussed by Renou, op. cit. 398.

[35] It is the case-marking of the object of comparison which provides secure evidence for deletion; thus structures like the following are common: NP^2_{acc} – *ná* [VP_i] VP_i NP^1_{acc}, *i.e. 'he* VP_i*'s* NP^1_{acc}, as [*he* VP_i*'s*] NP^2_{acc}*'*. Nearly all case-forms are attested as complements of *ná.*

[36] Certain rare and odd constructions with *ná* may still have to be explained by some sort of grammatical attraction, in particular the cases with NP^1_{nom} – *ná* NP^2_{nom}, where NP^1_{nom} is functionally a genitive (*svàr ná jyótiḥ*, 'like the sun('s) light', etc.; cf. the Dvipadā Virāj stanza quoted above in section 1); however, ceteris paribus, it is preferable not to resort to such an ill-defined principle.

[37] We do not refer to the occasional so-called 'tautological' combinations of *iva* and *ná*, where both particles are used for a single comparison (see Geldner ad 1.61.4 for examples.) Such cases simply attest to the weak (and ever-weakening) force of *iva.*